

To extract the audio, open a terminal and run the following command:

```
$ ffmpeg -i <video.mp4> -ab 256k <audio.mp3>
```

Here, *video.mp4* is the name of the video file. It can be of any other supported format. *audio.mp3* is the output file, which will have 256k as the bit rate.



Note: You need to have *ffmpeg* installed on your system to run the above command.

—Vishnu S,
vishnupanayara@gmail.com



Killing all the hanging user processes at one go

Sometimes an application stops working and all the processes associated with it are still left hanging on the server. Here is a command that will kill multiple processes in a jiffy:

```
#ps -ef | grep userid | awk '{print $2}' | xargs kill -9
```

...where *userid* is the user's login ID or could be your application process ID. You can use the kill option rather than kill -9 but the former doesn't work sometimes; so you can forcefully kill processes by using the -9 option.

—Sonu Tripathi,
sonu.tripathi@gmail.com



File encryption using OpenSSL

Here is a tip that will let you encrypt a file using OpenSSL. To see how this is done, first create a file *a.txt*:

```
#touch a.txt
```

Now, encrypt this file using the following command:

```
#openssl enc -aes-256-cbc -salt -in a.txt -out a.out  
enter aes-256-cbc encryption password:
```

```
Verifying - enter aes-256-cbc encryption password:
```

Enter a secret password to encrypt. This will be needed to decrypt the file later.

After running the above command, you have an encrypted file named *a.out*. To view the contents of *a.out*, decrypt the file first.

Run the following command to decrypt the file:

```
#openssl enc -d -aes-256-cbc -in a.out
```

This will show you the contents of the file. Happy encryption!

—Vinayak Pandey,
vinayakpandeyit@gmail.com



Find the process ID by using the *pgrep* command

You can obtain the process ID of the running process by using the *pgrep* command. This will display the process ID on *stdout*. Let us look at an example:

```
[narendra@tmp]$ pgrep bash
```

```
1510
```

In the above example, *pgrep* gives the output 1510, which is the process ID of bash.

—Narendra Kangralkar,
narendrakangralkar@gmail.com



Read config files without # comments

Most of the Linux config files are very big, if you read them with comments. Because of that, you have to use the page-down button, and sometimes you end up getting confused. Now, in the *httpd.conf* or any such file that has too many comments, if you want to read only the required configuration lines, use the following command and enjoy reading the file without comments:

```
#grep -v ^# /etc/httpd/conf/httpd.conf | less
```

Or you can create a new file without # by using the following command:

```
grep -v ^# /etc/httpd/conf/httpd.conf > newconf.config
```

This command will ignore all lines starting with the '#' symbol.

—Bhushan Patil,
bhushanvpatil@gmail.com

END

Share Your Linux Recipes!

The joy of using Linux is in finding ways to get around problems—take them head on, defeat them! We invite you to share your tips and tricks with us for publication in OSFY so that they can reach a wider audience. Your tips could be related to administration, programming, troubleshooting or general tweaking. Submit them at www.linuxforu.com. The sender of each published tip will get a T-shirt.